

36. THE NEURAL PLATE IN PRACTICE

DURATION : 18:22

STUDY SHEET

COURSE SUMMARY

This video addresses the fundamental concept of bodily rebalancing in biodynamic osteopathy, with an emphasis on the body's homogeneity. Practitioners learn to position themselves correctly to allow for a subtle perception of imbalances in the body, while remaining centred. The video explores how practitioners can identify different densities and sensations in the physical, etheric, astral, and mental systems, while facilitating the patient's self-organisation through a gentle and respectful approach. Practical rebalancing and observation techniques are detailed, offering students valuable tools to improve their practice and sensitivity as therapists.

36. THE PRACTICAL NEURAL PLATE: REBALANCING AND PERCEPTION

I. REBALANCING THROUGH HOMOGENEITY

We will seek the **important plane of closure** and carry out **rebalancing** work. The body is approached as a unit, divided into four parts.

The finger position is above, to the left and right, at the occipital level. The hands are positioned above, below, to the left and right, sub-occipitally.

A well-functioning and integrated body exhibits **homogeneity**. This means there is no noticeable difference between top and bottom, left and right. Restoring this homogeneity is a fundamental technique in **biodynamics**.

This is one of the first things to learn: to restore and perform a **rebalancing**. This work is particularly important for the **nervous system**, as it organises a large part of our body, including the vegetative, emotional, and limbic systems.

What we are doing here is somewhat the "starter" for this system.

II. POSITIONING AND PERCEPTION

When we position ourselves, we adopt a **precise** and very gentle **posture**, working mainly with two fingers. We settle gently, without pressure. Immediately, the **micro-crystalline field** appears.

When I speak of the micro-crystalline field, I am referring to the perception of the body as a unit, a complete individual. While maintaining this global vision, I position myself at this level and observe.

A. THE IMPORTANCE OF PRACTITIONER CENTRING

I must first be very **centred** myself. If I am off-centre, my perception will be altered. That is why a period of centring is essential.

Meditation is important for assessing my own state. There are days when one is more in form and others when one is less so. One must recognise one's state so as not to influence the person being treated. You must not induce, but only receive.

B. OBSERVING IMBALANCES

As you position yourself, you may feel **densities** or sensations. For example:

- One side more swollen.
- Excessive upward force, typical of people who are very "in their heads".
- An empty space.
- An overflow.
- Dissociations or sensations of spiralling, twisting.
- Areas of excessive heat.

We will begin by simply placing our hands and feeling the homogeneity or lack thereof in the system. Then, we can delve deeper, by questioning the different levels of the body.

C. SEEKING LEVELS OF AWARENESS

We will seek the different **bodies** or types of information combinations:

- The physical body
- The etheric body
- The astral (emotional) body
- The mental body

I find myself with different combinations, potentially 64 according to the **I Ching**. I look for the spaces that appear. Does my body react physically? If not, is it an etheric problem? Astral (purely emotional)? Mental?

The body can give information through a word, a gesture, a look, or even release patterns or past memories. This is the time to listen.

III. PRACTICAL APPLICATION OF REBALANCING

For example, I feel a greater **density** in the lower left, a slight descent of the left system. I let my sensation appear without delving into it.

I step back, I observe, and I focus on health. I just provide points of support. I am on a structure, a kind of remnant, a scar. I have a good **fulcrum** with my body, a good point of support.

I am in the globality. I do not focus on one section, but on the whole. I adjust myself so that my points of support, though gentle, are the most effective, and that I myself am in balance.

A. TAKING HOLD AND RESPECT

I receive the imbalance and allow the body to organise itself, observing its respiration. I hold the head like a bowl of water filled to the brim. This leads me to a deep respect for what I touch.

You are touching a powerful system, and you are just giving it support, very gently. Already, the state has changed. What I am doing is giving space, well-being.

I remain focused on health. The body rebalances gently. You will feel that it is both pleasant and powerful at a deeper level. This is the first layer of work here, I observe.

B. THE EVOLUTION OF PERCEPTION

There is always this descending respiration, its exhalation. I am halfway there, I wait. Then, I enter another rhythm. I open myself to the space around the person.

I perceive the person in the room, as if I saw myself with them in the universe. There is a change of rhythm at the heart level. It still seeks the image, then it stabilises. Another level appears.

I see it, but I remain focused on health until a state of homogeneity is reached, until this base is activated.

C. THE PATIENT'S SENSATIONS

At first, I had the impression of waves passing through one side, then the other of the body. After perceiving the globality, it was more like jerky movements, going right, left.

In the end, I felt that my breathing allowed me to relax. Often, at the end of a treatment, after some work, this rebalancing is performed. It is a key point for balancing the nervous system, as that is where it forms.

I position myself at this level, and I must have the same density as below. I place myself in this globality and observe what appears. For example, with her, it was a bit like that, a bit blocked. I stay, I do not intervene.

IV. TRUST IN HEALTH AND NON-INTERVENTION

How do you distinguish if you are on health or not? If you do not get drawn into the lesion and you remain present. The **fulcrum** of health is a fulcrum of presence.

It is being in the globality, in trust towards the whole, and knowing that health is what offers the possibility of **self-healing**. I invoke this principle, I let it act because it is more powerful than me.

At first, I placed myself in the globality, then I looked for another plane, I observed her respiration, and I went underneath. We did what we started yesterday. I placed myself in this perception, and another perception appeared. I again allowed the system to reorganise itself.

A. THE NATURAL CLARITY OF THE SYSTEM (ANALOGY OF CLEAR WATER)

Health is immutable. It's as if you put mud in clear water. You no longer see the clarity. But if you let the water settle, the clarity returns. The nature of the water has not changed.

You must rise into this nature. There is a part of you – it's a Buddhist principle – that possesses this clarity, this health, this power. I place myself at this level. This approach has a reorganising power.

The only thing I do is provide points of support so that the system seeks and reorganises itself. I trust these principles. My question is: do you trust this?

B. INITIATION TO LISTENING

This is an initiation to listening to this movement, this power. An initiation to receiving information and participating in it.

For now, we have only seen the body and the beginnings of the nervous system, with the first closure. That already seems like a lot. Finally, we arrive at birth and we redo all the birth work in osteopathy with this embryological vision.

It's no stranger than anything else. Fortunately, we don't consciously remember it! However, your unconscious understood very well and was uncomfortable. It reacted immediately: I breathed, I'm hungry, I'm cold. It's quite a violent experience.

V. THE UNCONSCIOUS AND RESISTANCE TO CHANGE

This makes a good introduction for the "teaser". A part of you has observed that all change is dangerous. Every time you are confronted with a change, even a beneficial one, a part of you reacts.

"We already know this benefit, we already know the parameters. I know your idea, go away. I'm not changing." And you are immediately brought back into your security patterns, into your "comfort zone", even if it is uncomfortable.

Sometimes, change is a good thing. There is a way to work with the unconscious, because we are confronted with it. Tissues do not lie. When we are on the tissues, we are confronted with our own **inner lies**.

It is important to discover these lies that we all carry and to dare to confront them. But that takes time.

A. THE UNSAID AND THE CONSTRUCTION OF SELF

Sometimes, things should not be said, it's not the right time. It's omission. They are not said at the moment, but perhaps later, or perhaps never. These **unsaid things** that we carry are the foundations upon which we build ourselves.

It's a subtle lie. We all have them. It's good to seek this **authenticity**, even if it's not always pleasant.

B. OBSTACLES TO MEDITATION AND PRESENCE

A part of you does not want to change. This is the first obstacle in meditation: laziness, or something else. There are different types of meditation.

I first did "floating" meditations that were very nice. Then I had the chance to meet a master who taught me meditation by starting with the basics: working the mind, facing its wandering.

Learning to return to one's object of attention, to train oneself in that. It's sometimes boring. Then, one begins to perceive a quality of **presence** that appears. Because when you know you are no longer there, you can return to your presence.

I offer you a meditation that brings a quality of presence, of attention, something that is good for the body, mind, and soul. It is interesting to see that studies on meditation show the activation of a part of our brain: the **prefrontal cortex**.

The prefrontal cortex has the ability to open us up, because we often operate in automatic patterns. It allows us to leave that and access another plane, another moment of the brain. It has been discovered that a specific area there activates empathy, but a just empathy, a compassion.